

SKOAR!

DARKSIDERS II

Death Lives!

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You play as Death, one of the four horsemen of the Apocalypse who is on a journey to prove the innocence of his brother - War and to restore humanity. It isn't necessary that you play the first game to know what's going on this time around but if you have, you will see some familiar faces and will feel right at home with the look and feel of the game and how the story pans out.

One down side to the game is that it's easy to forget or not care about the story as it will move slowly if you are one who easily gets absorbed in the side quests and missions of the game.

The action in the game is quite good and we are happy to say that the controls aren't as complicated as the first game. Death's primary weapons are two scythes, which he can use to take down the enemies, and you have access to a plethora of other secondary weapons such as hammers, axes and more that help you mix up the combos. Some of the secondary "heavy" weapons are slow and can cause a lot of damage. Death also has access to a gun, which adds to the combat of the game, something we loved in the Devil May Cry games.

The Puzzles and side quests can cost you many sleepless nights and borrow heavily from the Zelda franchise. There is a puzzle

around every corner and it can be something as simple as finding a key to open a locked door or something more complex as restoring the supply of lava and water to a forge.

Another element where puzzles are introduced is with respect to the boss fights. Not all bosses can be taken down with hacks and slashes. Some require strategic thinking and that adds to the variation in gameplay keeping it fresh.

The level up system in Darksiders 2 has been redone when compared to the first game. When you start out as Death, you are puny and have limited abilities. In a matter of few hours, we had upgraded the scythes to almost full, unlocked some nice special abilities and pimped Death out to look like a badass – a very satisfying experience.

The graphics of the game are good if not the best in the business. You will encounter a variety of location from dark and gritty dungeons to the lush out doors. All the locations look beautiful and have a distinct feel. Textures look sharp for the most part and the overall ambience of the levels in the game is very good. The voice acting of the game is satisfying and well done but it is difficult to feel attached to any of the characters. There is the witty joke here and the sarcastic comment there, but nothing in totality to keep you fulfilled. The background score is very well varied with adrenalin pumping tunes during battle and soft orchestral scores while navigating the environment. ✨



Verdict

If you are a completionist, you can easily derive 20+ hours from the game making it a bang for your buck. Apart from that, Darksiders 2 plays it safe by borrowing elements from popular franchises. If you are looking for an action adventure game with clever puzzle elements thrown into the mix then this is definitely the game for you.

MOAR!

- » **Developer:** Vigil Games
- » **Publisher:** THQ
- » **Platforms:** Xbox 360, PS3, Wii U and PC
- » **Price:** PC: ₹999 Xbox ₹360 and PS3: ₹2,799

